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News

The First Trailer Of 'Alien: Romulus' Teases A Gritty

And Glorious Return To The Franchise's Horror Roots

The piece looks to bring back more hungry face-huggers and claustrophobic terrors. Photo courtesy of 20th Century Fox.

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The first teaser for “Alien: Romulus” promises audiences a full return-to-form to the famous series’ gory horror elements. The Fede Álvarez-directed film is set to land in theaters on August 16.

This prequel installment takes place prior to the events of “Aliens,” but after the first film, featuring a much younger cast. The details about the overall plot are still under wraps, but according to [IMDb](#) synopsis: “Young people from a distant world must face the most terrifying life form in the universe.” Cailee Spaeny, the breakout star of “Priscilla” and starring in the upcoming and highly anticipated A24’s “Civil War,” takes charge in the teaser that somehow resembles the fearful, yet confident Sigourney Weaver’s Ripley at the end. Other team members on this tragic ship include Isabela Merced, David Jonsson, Spike Fearn, Aileen Wu, and Archie Renaux

Just within a few seconds of the teaser, a mixture between long tracking shots of the bloody interior of the ship with claustrophobic spaces and sound bites of horrifying screaming and pleading automatically pulls the franchise’s back to what it is known for: cosmic horror that features an undefeatable monster. Through multiple jump cuts of the events, tensions are built to an undeniable explosion—a hint to Álvarez’s determination to bring the franchise

back to its iconic single-location horror film with intricate low lighting environments and terrifying sound designs.

Based on the teaser, there are numerous throwbacks to the original film that deliver nostalgic feels while honoring the franchise' legacy. The siren at the beginning of the trailer is a straight homage to the first film—the same iconic low frequency siren that carries a terrifying fear in the air. Plus, the incorporated details of the familiar pulse rifles and the overall set designs really capture the first installment's claustrophobic feeling while extending the series' lore and world buildings.

Álvarez leads the next installment back to the gruesome feels of Ridley Scott's "Alien" in 1979 and the action-fueled adrenaline of James Cameron's directed sequel "Aliens" in 1986. Known for his famous directorial features (2016's *Don't Breathe* and 2013's *Evil Dead*), Álvarez will surely implement his inventive horror elements that would make this prequel stand out from rest, yet honoring the franchise's legacy.

Furthermore, During Álvarez's conversation with Guillermo del Toro at the [DGA Latio Summit 2023](#), he got a big approval from Scott, who is also the lead producer of the film, about the overall quality. Álvarez mentioned that he was super nervous about the original film's director seeing his recreation for the franchise, imagining Scott saying "You destroy my legacy."

"[Scott] did say," Álvarez recalled. "Fede, what can I say, "It's f—ing great." Having the stamp of approval from the original director gives great hype to the film, on top of the dreadful snippets of what events to expect from Álvarez's "Alien: Romulus."

"Alien: Romulus" lands in theaters on August 16. Catch the first teaser below.



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